over the Himalayas—a long, hard journey full of peril. Many Indians and Chinese perished on the way, and one account *says* that as many as 90 per cent of these pilgrims perished. Many having managed to reach the end of their journey did not return **and** settled in the land of their adoption. There was another route **also,** not much safer, though probably shorter: this was by sea **via** Indo-China, Java, and Sumatra, Malaya and the Nicobar **Islands.** This was also frequently used, and sometimes a pilgrim **travelled** overland and returned by sea. Buddhism and Indian

culture had spread all over Central Asia and in parts of Indonesia, and there were large numbers of monasteries and study centres dotted all over these vast areas. Travellers from India or China thus found a welcome and shelter along these routes by land and sea. Sometimes scholars from China would break journey for a few months at some Indian colony in Indonesia in order to learn Sanskrit before they came to India.

The first record of an Indian scholar's visit to China is that of Kashyapa Matanga who reached China in 67 **A.D**. in the reign of the Emperor Ming Ti and probably at his invitation. He settled